

Remcos Malware Report

Remcos — Malware Analysis Report

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1. Executive Summary

Remcos is a commercially distributed remote administration and surveillance tool that is frequently abused as a RAT. ANY.RUN's current tracker ranked it third by recent public task volume, and its family page listed recent activity on 2026-06-01. MITRE tracks Remcos as software S0332 and documents malicious campaign use. Remcos risk is high because it enables remote control, surveillance, credential theft, payload execution, and persistence while also having legitimate-administration cover.

Confirmed unauthorized Remcos activity should be treated as interactive remote access. Response should include host isolation, credential resets, RMM inventory review, firewall/proxy log analysis, and hunting for lateral movement or follow-on payloads.

2. Sample Metadata

Field	Assessment
Family	Remcos
Type	Remote administration tool abused as RAT
Platform	Windows
First seen	ANY.RUN lists 2016-06-01
Recent activity	ANY.RUN lists last seen 2026-06-01; tracker showed 257 tasks in last seven days
Common delivery	Phishing, ClickFix/fake CAPTCHA, MSI/DLL sideloading, archive/script chains
Confidence	High for capabilities; medium for campaign-specific infrastructure

3. Source Review & Confidence

Claim	Source	Date	Confidence	Notes
Remcos is commercially distributed and frequently abused for unauthorized remote actions.	ANY.RUN Remcos overview	Accessed 2026-06-01	High	Family overview.
Remcos is tracked by MITRE as S0332 and observed in malware campaigns.	MITRE ATT&CK S0332	Last modified 2026-04-23	High	ATT&CK software entry.
Remcos remains active in recent public sandbox telemetry.	ANY.RUN Malware Trends Tracker	Accessed 2026-06-01	High	Current ranking.
Recent campaigns used fake AI/OpenClaw-style lures and MSI/DLL sideloading to deploy Remcos.	Public advisories / secondary summaries	2026-05	Medium	Validate per sample.

3.1 Expanded Source Matrix

Source	Contribution	Confidence
ANY.RUN tracker and Remcos page	Current prevalence and sandbox-derived family context.	High
MITRE ATT&CK S0332	Long-term technique mapping.	High
Fortinet January 2026 campaign	Fake shipping document, fileless execution, PowerShell/.NET module, process hollowing, and Remcos payload details.	High
Trellix March 2026 report	Phishing-to-memory chain using JavaScript, PowerShell, managed code injection, and fileless Remcos execution.	High
Broadcom protection bulletin	Independent summary of Trellix-observed multi-stage deployment.	Medium / High
Tata Communications May 2026 advisory	Recent fake AI/OpenClaw-themed Remcos delivery context.	Medium
Fortinet earlier Remcos analysis	Historical feature set and phishing tradecraft.	Medium / High

3.2 Evidence Ledger

Claim	Evidence	Confidence	Analyst Note
Remcos is a legitimate commercial remote administration tool widely abused as malware.	ANY.RUN, MITRE, Fortinet.	High	Authorization context is critical.
Recent Remcos campaigns increasingly use multi-stage and fileless execution.	Fortinet 2026, Trellix 2026, Broadcom 2026.	High for observed campaigns	Do not assume every Remcos sample is fileless.
Phishing and fake business documents remain common initial access.	Fortinet and Trellix campaign reporting.	High	Procurement/shipping/RFQ themes recur.
Remcos enables surveillance, remote control, data exfiltration, and follow-on payloads.	MITRE and vendor reports.	High	Treat as operator access, not simple commodity malware.

4. Payload Variants and Delivery

Remcos is often delivered as a final payload after social engineering. Recent reporting includes fake CAPTCHA/ClickFix flows, malicious Google Storage or cloud-themed lures, MSI installers, DLL sideloading, and fake AI tooling instructions. Since Remcos can be positioned as a legitimate remote administration tool, defenders should focus on unauthorized execution context, persistence, C2, and operator behavior.

4.1 Ecosystem and Operator Notes

Remcos has a gray-zone identity: it is marketed as remote administration software but frequently appears in unauthorized access campaigns. That makes inventory and authorization central to analysis. The question is not merely "is this Remcos?" but "was this deployment approved, from an approved toolchain, to an approved endpoint, with expected infrastructure?"

Recent campaigns show a shift toward layered loaders and memory-resident execution. A defensive program that only searches for the final Remcos executable will miss JavaScript, PowerShell, .NET injector, process hollowing, and sideloading stages.

5. Infection Chain Analysis

1. User interacts with phishing lure, copied command, fake installer, or malicious document/archive.
2. Script, MSI, or loader deploys Remcos payload.
3. Payload may use packing, encrypted configuration, or DLL sideloading.
4. Persistence is established through registry, startup, scheduled task, or service-like behavior depending on build.
5. Remcos connects to operator-controlled infrastructure and enables remote surveillance/control.
6. Operator may collect credentials, browse files, capture screen/keystrokes, and deploy follow-on tooling.

6. Technical Analysis

Behavioral priorities:

- Suspicious remote-control executable outside approved RMM inventory.
- Parent process from browser, Office, archive tool, script host, or MSI installer.
- Persistence from user-writable or unusual vendor paths.
- Screen capture, keylogging, clipboard access, and file browsing.
- Long-lived outbound C2 sessions to uncommon destinations.
- DLL sideloading via legitimate-looking installers or conferencing tools.

6.1 Static Analysis Expectations

For Remcos samples or loaders, review:

- Installer/script container: VBS, JS, MSI, Office, archive, or compiled loader.
- .NET injector metadata and embedded resources.

- Hollowing/injection target names such as RegSvcS . exe or legitimate signed processes.
- Encrypted Remcos configuration, C2 host/port, mutex, campaign ID, and persistence settings.
- Imports/APIs for process injection, screenshots, keylogging, registry writes, and network sockets.
- Code signing and masqueraded product names.

6.2 Dynamic Analysis Expectations

Collect:

- Email lure, attachment, archive, and script chain.
- PowerShell command line, encoded payloads, and downloaded stages.
- In-memory module loading and process hollowing telemetry.
- Persistence writes and service/task creation.
- Long-lived C2 sessions and operator commands.
- Screen capture, keylogging, clipboard, file browsing, and payload execution.

7. Indicators of Compromise

7.1 Indicator Summary

Indicator Class	Count	Confidence	Recommended Use
File hashes	Sample-specific	High	Exact-match sweep when sourced from sandbox.
IP/domain	Campaign-specific	Medium	Enrich and hunt.
Host indicators	Behavioral	High	Primary value.
Tool name	Remcos / remote-control artifacts	Medium	Context required due legitimate claims.

7.2 Source Notes

ANY.RUN provides rotating Remcos sample and infrastructure observations through the family page and public submissions. Because Remcos is actively maintained and infrastructure changes frequently, this report emphasizes behavior and detection logic over static IOC volume.

7.3 Host Indicators

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Notes
Process	Unknown remote-control binary spawned by browser, Office, script host, archive tool, or MSI	High	Strong initial triage signal.
Persistence	Startup/Run key/scheduled task for unknown executable	High	Validate signer and path.
Behavior	Keylogging, screen capture, clipboard access	High	RAT surveillance.

Type	Indicator	Confidence	Notes
Network	Long-lived outbound session to rare destination from unknown process	Medium	Hunt with process context.

7.4 IOC Usage Guidance

Remcos can overlap with legitimate remote administration claims. Do not classify solely on a filename. Validate authorization, deployment source, code signing, parent process, persistence, operator destination, and whether the endpoint belongs to an approved remote-management policy.

8. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Rationale
T1204.002	User Execution: Malicious File	Phishing and fake installer delivery.
T1059	Command and Scripting Interpreter	Scripted deployment chains.
T1574.002	DLL Side-Loading	Observed in recent Remcos delivery reporting.
T1547.001	Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	Common RAT persistence.
T1056.001	Keylogging	Surveillance capability.
T1113	Screen Capture	Remote monitoring.
T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	Follow-on payloads.
T1219	Remote Access Software	Remote administration tool abused for access.

9. Detection Engineering

Sigma - Unauthorized Remote Tool From Phishing Or Installer Chain

```

title: Suspicious Remote Control Tool Spawned From User Lure Chain
id: 1878b0d7-1e61-4d5b-9f2f-remcos-0001
status: experimental
description: Detects unknown remote-control or RAT-like binaries launched from common phishing, archive, script, or installer
references:
  - https://any.run/malware-trends/remcos/
  - https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0332/
author: Lost Boys Cyber
date: 2026-06-01
tags:
  - attack.command_and_control
  - attack.t1219
  - attack.execution
  - attack.t1204.002
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\msedge.exe'
      - '\firefox.exe'

```

```

- '\winword.exe'
- '\excel.exe'
- '\powershell.exe'
- '\wscript.exe'
- '\mshta.exe'
- '\msiexec.exe'
- '\7z.exe'
- '\winrar.exe'
selection_child:
  Image|contains:
    - '\AppData\'
    - '\Temp\'
    - '\Users\Public\'
condition: selection_parent and selection_child
falsepositives:
- Software installers and approved RMM deployment; tune with allowlisted hashes, signers, and deployment tools.
level: high

```

KQL Hunt

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe","msedge.exe","firefox.exe","winword.exe","excel.exe","powershell.exe","wscript.exe","mshta.exe","msiexec.exe","7z.exe","winrar.exe")
| where FolderPath has_any ("\\AppData\\", "\\Temp\\", "\\Users\\Public\\")
| join kind=leftouter (
  DeviceNetworkEvents
  | where Timestamp > ago(14d)
  | summarize FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), Destinations=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20), IPs=make_set(RemoteIP, 20) by DeviceId, IP
) on DeviceId

```

YARA - Remcos-Like RAT Strings

```

rule MAL_Win_Remcos_Like_RAT {
  meta:
    author = "Lost Boys Cyber"
    date = "2026-06-01"
    description = "Generic hunt for Remcos-like RAT functionality strings"
  strings:
    $r1 = "Remcos" ascii wide nocase
    $r2 = "keylogger" ascii wide nocase
    $r3 = "screenshot" ascii wide nocase
    $r4 = "clipboard" ascii wide nocase
    $r5 = "startup" ascii wide nocase
  condition:
    uint16(0) == 0x5A4D and 3 of them
}

```

10. Threat Hunting

Hypothesis: If Remcos is present, an unauthorized remote-control binary will be introduced by a phishing or installer chain and maintain outbound C2 while enabling surveillance behaviors.

Hunts:

- Unknown remote-access binaries launched by browsers, Office, script hosts, or MSI.
- New autoruns for user-profile executables.
- Screen capture/keylogging alerts paired with long-lived outbound sessions.
- Endpoints with remote-control tools not present in the approved RMM inventory.

10.1 Additional Hunt Queries

SPL:

```

index=endpoint (parent_process IN ("powershell.exe","wscript.exe","cscript.exe","mshta.exe","msiexec.exe","winword.exe","excel.exe","7z.exe","winrar.exe") OR (process_path="*\\AppData\\" OR process_path="*\\Temp\\" OR process_path="*\\Users\\Public\\"))

```

```
| stats earliest(_time) latest(_time) values(command_line) values(parent_command_line) by host user process_name process_
```

Memory-centric hunt:

Search for signed Windows processes with unusual network connections and suspicious memory regions shortly after PowerShell

11. Triage and Incident Response

- 1. Verify whether Remcos or similar remote-control software is authorized.
- 2. If unauthorized, isolate host and collect volatile process/network evidence.
- 3. Review operator actions, file access, credential access, and payload deployment.
- 4. Reset credentials and review RMM/VPN logs.
- 5. Hunt environment-wide for the same delivery chain and C2 destinations.

11.1 Authorization Decision Tree

Question	Why It Matters
Is Remcos or the observed remote tool in the approved software inventory?	Separates legitimate administration from abuse.
Was it deployed by an approved RMM/software deployment channel?	Phishing parentage indicates compromise.
Is the C2/admin host owned by the organization or vendor?	Unknown external operator infrastructure is high risk.
Does execution originate from user-writable paths or scripts?	Strong malicious indicator.
Are surveillance features active?	Indicates potential data exposure.

12. Validation and Emulation

Test detection logic against approved RMM and installer workflows to tune false positives. Emulate suspicious parent-child process chains in a lab without deploying Remcos.

13. Recommendations

Priority	Owner	Timeline	Action
Critical	IT / Security	24 hours	Maintain an approved remote-access tool inventory and alert on all other remote-control binaries.
High	SOC	7 days	Correlate lure-chain process ancestry with outbound C2.
High	Endpoint Engineering	7 days	Block unsigned binaries from user-writable paths where feasible.
Medium	Awareness	30 days	Train users on ClickFix/fake CAPTCHA and fake AI tooling lures.

14. References and Refresh Notes

- ANY.RUN Malware Trends Tracker: <https://anyrun.de/malware-trends/>
- ANY.RUN Remcos overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/remcos/>
- MITRE ATT&CK Remcos S0332: <https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0332/>
- Fortinet January 2026 Remcos shipping-document campaign: <https://www.fortinet.com/blog/threat-research/new-remcos-campaign-distributed-through-fake-shipping-document>
- Trellix fileless multi-stage Remcos campaign: <https://www.trellix.com/blogs/research/fileless-multi-stage-remcos-rat-phishing-to-memory/>
- Broadcom protection bulletin for multi-staged Remcos deployment: <https://www.broadcom.com/support/security-center/protection-bulletin/multi-staged-remcos-rat-deployment-campaign>
- Fortinet Remcos phishing campaign analysis: <https://www.fortinet.com/blog/threat-research/latest-remcos-rat-phishing>
- Tata Communications advisory on fake DeepSeek/OpenClaw Remcos activity: <https://www.tatacommunications.com/hubfs/library/threat-advisory/documents/threat-intelligence-advisory-19-may-2026.pdf>
- ANY.RUN Malware Trends Report 2025: <https://any.run/cybersecurity-blog/malware-trends-2025/>

14.1 Intelligence Gaps

- Authorization context cannot be solved from public reporting.
- Fileless campaigns may require EDR memory and script-block telemetry.
- C2 protocol and configuration vary by build/operator.
- Public IoCs age quickly; behavior remains more durable.